

or BA. The reason for this obvious career progression is the tester/QA analyst's involvement in the end-to-end business process. For instance, during the early stage of a project when requirements are floated around among developers and testers, the testers are expected to study, understand and remember each and every word of the requirement. In contrast, the developers need only focus on their specific module. This ends up giving testers an edge when switching over to a BA profile.

Certifications – The entry pass

Though it's not mandatory to be certified to find work as a software tester in the industry, it's a useful add-on. Software testing certifications can be acquired either before entering the industry or while working with an organisation. There are various internationally acclaimed certifications such as CSTE, CSQA and ISTQB available in the market to assess the knowledge of software testing at all experience levels. Let's take a quick look at these certifications:

ISTQB

International Software Testing Qualifications Board (ISTQB) has two levels

